

L'chaim To Life!

L'chaim! To life! Let us wish ourselves health, endless happiness and the strength to express our identity with pride.

On Purim, we celebrate the Jews' miraculous rescue from annihilation more than 2,000 years ago in ancient Persia. Haman, wicked advisor to King Ahasuerus, despised the idea of Jewish identity and convinced the King to kill anyone who retained it.

The Jews didn't back down. They were worried; they prayed, they fasted and they were stressed. But their commitment to their heritage was strong, and they were ultimately saved.



On Purim we rejoice. We take the opportunity to bask in the beauty of our identity, an ancient heritage which guides us, and we uncover our own deep commitment to our Jewish identity today, even in the face of challenge.

L'chaim!



THE MITZVOT OF PURIM

Listen to the Megillah

To relive the miraculous events of Purim, listen to the reading of the Megillah (the scroll of Esther) twice: once on Purim eve, Saturday night, February 23, 2013 and again on Purim day, Sunday February 24, 2013.



Send Food Portions to Friends (Mishloach Manot)

On Purim we emphasize the importance of Jewish unity and friendship by sending gifts of food to friends. On Purim day, February 24, 2013, send a gift of at least two kinds of ready-to-eat foods (e.g. pastry, fruit, beverage), to at least one friend.



Give to the Needy (Matanot Laevyonim)

Concern for the needy is a year-round responsibility; but on Purim it is a special Mitzvah to remember the poor. Give charity to at least two (but preferably more) needy individuals on Purim day, February 24, 2013.



Eat, Drink, and be Merry

Purim should be celebrated with a special festive meal on Purim day, at which family and friends gather together to rejoice in the Purim spirit. It is a Mitzvah to drink wine or other inebriating drinks at this meal.



HAPPY PURIM!